

I believe the current system for regulating short-term rentals in San Francisco provides some level of accountability, but it is ultimately inadequate. Even though hosts are required to register with the city, Airbnb is expected to display policy numbers, the enforcement largely depends on third parties for identifying and filing complaints. This approach places the burden of accountability on individuals rather than on the platform or the regulatory agencies. The SWE Code of Ethics says that software engineers should prioritize the public good and ensure that systems are designed to minimize harm. If Airbnb implemented automated verification of policy numbers before allowing listings to be posted, then they could have stronger accountability. Additionally, the city could take a more proactive approach and audit listings instead of waiting for complaints. These changes would shift the responsibility to the organizations with the most control over the system and improve overall compliance.

One important factor to consider about the legality of web scraping is whether the data being scraped is publicly accessible without bypassing security measures. Legal debates surrounding the Computer Fraud and Abuse Act (CFAA) often focus on whether accessing publicly available data constitutes unauthorized access. This distinction is important because scraping publicly available data may serve beneficial purposes, such as research or public accountability, but scraping data behind login pages or restricted systems may violate laws and ethical boundaries. Therefore, determining whether data is truly public and whether scraping respects a website's terms of service is an important consideration when discussing the legality of web scraping.

1) Before scraping data, it's important to know where that data came from and whether it was ethically sourced or not. If data was illegally scraped or without permission, then further distribution of the data, even if public, is unethical.

2) It's also important to know the impacts and consequences of propagating certain data sets. If data contains personal information that could be harmful to people such as court records, social media accounts, or private information, it can be harmful to utilize those records even for personal projects.